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ARTS 310

5 December 2025

Project 3 Statement

My intention for this project was to create a game that teaches players how designers think, not through text or theory, but through a fast, visual, and collaborative experience that mirrors real creative decision-making. I wanted a format that would push players to interpret ideas quickly, take risks, communicate visually, and adapt with limited information. These are all core behaviors of the design process. My experiences playing Codenames online with friends shaped the foundation of the game. I always enjoyed the mix of competition, speed, and the subtle tension of having to communicate an idea indirectly. Translating that feeling into a tool for design education felt natural. Instead of giving word clues, players sketch under a strict time limit, which places them in a situation similar to real design work, where they must distill complex ideas into simple, communicative visuals.

The project's goal of representing the designer–client relationship influenced how the guessing and interpretation phases function. A single sketch becomes the “brief,” and teammates act as the “client,” trying to understand and make decisions based on incomplete or ambiguous information. Misinterpretations mirror the real challenges designers face when presenting work, while successful guesses reward clarity, iteration, and thoughtful communication. The variety of process cards also reinforces the educational purpose of the game. Each card represents a step or tool within the design process, and assigning different point values encourages players to recognize that some stages require heavier conceptual thinking than others. By competing for the highest score, players indirectly learn how important it is to manage priorities, understand complexity, and make strategic design choices.

Visually, I chose the typeface Elizeth for its clean structure and blocky serifs, which support the minimalist and functional aesthetic I wanted. Its controlled geometry reflects the systematized nature of design thinking, yet the typeface still has enough character to keep the game from feeling clinical. The

combination of Elizeth and minimal layouts keeps the components readable during quick play and reinforces the idea that clarity of communication is a designer's primary tool.

Overall, the game is meant to be both instructive and playful. It emphasizes behavior, iteration, interpretation, and visual problem solving, which are all fundamental aspects of design practice. It also allows players from different backgrounds to engage with these ideas through an inclusive and accessible format. By blending the competitive mystery of Codenames with the communicative demands of sketching, the game offers a hands-on way to explore why design thinking adds value and how strong processes lead to strong outcomes.